



TO RUSSIA WITH LOVE

In the first deal of its kind, wealthy French industrialists Paul and Pierre Lebaudy built the airship Lebaudy 6, "La Russie" (above), for export to Russia in 1909. Seven years earlier the brothers had sponsored engineer Henri Julliot's construction of a semirigid airship, nicknamed "Le Jaune" (The Yellow One).

the celebrations for King George V's coronation. The following month, Earle L. Ovington carried mail from an aviation meeting on Long Island to Mineola, New York, dropping a mail sack over the side of his Blériot monoplane into a field behind the post office. Before World War I airmail services did not develop beyond this experimental stage.

The only sustained airplane passenger service at this time was provided by the Saint Petersburg-Tampa Airboat Line in Florida during the opening months of 1914. Some 1,200 passengers paid \$5 for the 23-minute flight across Tampa Bay in a Benoist flying boat, but the service did not survive the end of the tourist season. The potential of airplanes as passenger or freight transportation was severely limited by their inability to

"Behind us lies the last period of German weakness and inferiority. The future of Germany is in the air!"

RUDOLF MARTIN

GERMAN AIRSHIP ENTHUSIAST, WRITING IN 1910

